Sara Haddad

Junior Backend Engineer - AI Applications

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Backend-focused software engineer with strong Python fundamentals and 18 months of hands-on API development. Experienced with FastAPI, Django, PostgreSQL, testing, Docker and CI/CD. Has integrated LLM features into production-style services but has less direct experience with complex autonomous agents and advanced retrieval pipelines.

KEY STRENGTHS

- Strongest software-engineering fundamentals among the five profiles: testing, API design, CI/CD and observability.
- Integrated LLM summarization and structured extraction into existing backend services.
- Good production instincts around permissions, validation, error handling and rollback-safe changes.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Junior Backend Developer | CedarStack Software - Amman, Jordan — **Mar 2025 - Present**

- Develops FastAPI and Django REST services used by internal operations teams; owns endpoints from schema design through testing and deployment.
- Reduced median API response time by 24% on a reporting service through query optimization, pagination and Redis caching.
- Added an LLM-based document summarization endpoint with structured JSON output, request quotas and logging; implemented deterministic fallback behavior when the model is unavailable.
- Built GitHub Actions pipelines for linting, pytest, image builds and staging deployment.
- Participates in peer review and writes migration plans for database changes.

Software Engineering Intern | NorthPeak Digital - Amman, Jordan — **Jul 2024 - Feb 2025**

- Implemented CRUD APIs, JWT authentication and role-based access controls for a B2B portal.
- Wrote integration tests for database and API behavior and helped containerize local development with Docker Compose.
- Integrated email and payment sandbox APIs with idempotency and retry handling.

SELECTED PROJECTS

AI Meeting Notes Service - *FastAPI, OpenAI API, PostgreSQL, Celery*

Built an asynchronous service that accepts transcripts, produces summaries/action items, validates outputs against a schema and stores versioned results. Added retries and dead-letter handling for failed jobs.

Tool-Calling Helpdesk Prototype - *Python, OpenAI API, SQLite*

Built a small assistant with three explicit tools: user lookup, ticket status and ticket creation. Enforced allow-listed tool calls and confirmation before write operations.

Inventory API Platform - *Django REST Framework, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker*

Designed a tested multi-tenant backend with role permissions, caching, filtering and CI checks. No LLM component; included to demonstrate core engineering depth.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend	Python, FastAPI, Django, Django REST Framework, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, SQL, Redis, Celery
LLM Apps	OpenAI API, structured outputs, prompt design, function calling basics, token/cost awareness
Testing	pytest, unittest, integration testing, mocking, Postman
DevOps	Docker, Docker Compose, GitHub Actions, Linux, Nginx basics, AWS EC2/RDS/S3 basics
Engineering	Git, code review, API versioning, RBAC, logging, monitoring fundamentals
Languages	Arabic - Native | English - Full professional proficiency

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Software Engineering | Princess Sumaya University for Technology — **2020 - 2024**

GPA: 3.48/4.00 | Senior project: Workflow Automation Platform for Small Businesses

CERTIFICATIONS & LEARNING

- AWS Educate - Getting Started with Compute (2025)
- Postman API Fundamentals Student Expert (2024)